K9 Agent — DA Direkt Dog Insurance

AI-native Research, Quote & Bind

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Name of the Team

Retail_Agentic_Commerce_LiviuGhenghea

Selected Use Case

01 — Agentic Commerce for the Personal Agent Era

Main Learning from Experience

Building directly on the Anthropic API (no framework) kept the system transparent and fast. Agent-to-agent commerce patterns are technically feasible today with existing APIs.

Team Members

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How your approach is solving the problem

K9 Agent replaces the existing linear web funnel with a fully AI-native, conversational insurance journey. A Zurich-hosted AI agent (powered by Claude Sonnet) understands natural language, calls 12 live DA Direkt APIs in real time, and guides customers from their first question to a bound policy — without a single form or dropdown. The architecture is built for agent-to-agent commerce: a customer-owned personal AI agent can interact directly with the Zurich K9 Agent, enabling autonomous quote and bind with no human in the loop. This directly addresses the five AS-IS pain points: relevance, understanding, engagement, transparency and purchase guidance.

What the results of the prototype are

• **Live working prototype** deployed at https://k9agent.streamlit.app • Full journey demonstrated: breed lookup → live pricing → lead creation → bind • **18/18 API smoke tests passing** against DA Direkt beta environment • Real leads created in DA Direkt's system with valid reference numbers • Handles natural language, follow-up questions, and edge cases without breaking • Cost per full journey: ~€0.05 (Sonnet + Haiku models)

What are the next steps for scaling your solution

• **MCP server**: expose tools as Model Context Protocol server — any personal agent can discover and call the Zurich Agent • **Production APIs**: swap beta URL → production, rotate API key • **Multi-channel**: same agent core serves WhatsApp, web chat, voice • **Multi-product**: extend to cat insurance, liability, life with minimal changes • **Prompt caching**: reduce Sonnet costs by ~80% at scale • **Session persistence**: Redis for conversation state across channels

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Problem Approach & Solution Design

Replacing the linear web funnel with an AI-native, agent-to-agent insurance journey

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THE PROBLEM — 5 AS-IS PAIN POINTS

■ Relevance

Customers can't see how the product connects to their pet's specific needs. Answers don't match their actual questions.

■ Understanding

Complex terminology, unclear plan differences, no breed/age-specific guidance. Surgery vs full coverage not intuitive.

■ Engagement

Customers can't visualise what the claims experience looks like. Network coverage and real-life usage unclear.

■ Transparency + Drop-off

Premium logic opaque. Pre-existing conditions cause drop-offs. Application process feels complex and error-prone.

THE SOLUTION — HOW K9 AGENT SOLVES IT

■ AI-native conversation

Natural language replaces forms. Claude understands 'my Golden Retriever is 2 years old' in one message.

■ Live pricing + transparency

Real-time prices from DA Direkt APIs. Explains GOT factors, deductibles, and exclusions in plain language.

■ Agent-to-agent commerce

Personal AI agents can call the Zurich K9 Agent directly via tool-use protocol. No human in the loop.

ARCHITECTURE IN ONE LINE

Customer Agent (Haiku — fast, cheap) → natural language → **Zurich K9 Agent** (Sonnet — reasoning + 12 tools) → REST calls → **DA Direkt Petolo APIs** (live breeds / pricing / leads / bind)

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Results & Key Insights

Working prototype validated against live DA Direkt beta APIs

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KEY METRICS

18/18
API Tests
All smoke tests passing

12
Tools
Live DA Direkt API calls

6
Plans Quoted
Real-time pricing all tiers

~€0.05
Cost/Journey
Sonnet + Haiku combined

100%
Conversational
No forms, no dropdowns

KEY INSIGHTS

■ Full journey end-to-end

From first message to insurance application submission — live leads created in DA Direkt's beta system with real reference numbers. Deployed at https://k9agent.streamlit.app.

■ Genuine AI understanding

Agent handles natural language, follow-up questions, breed ambiguity, and unexpected inputs without breaking. No rigid step sequence — the conversation adapts to the customer.

■ Agent-to-agent ready

Architecture designed so any MCP-compatible personal agent can discover and call the Zurich K9 Agent tools directly. No UI required — pure agent-to-agent API interaction.

AS-IS vs TO-BE COMPARISON

Dimension	AS-IS (Today)	K9 Agent (TO-BE)
Customer effort	Navigate 5-step web form	**Single conversation, any device**
Coverage clarity	PDF documents, buried terms	**Plain-language explanation on demand**
Pricing transparency	Calculator with fixed inputs	**Live prices across all plans, scenario-based**
Pre-existing conditions	Drop-off, unclear guidance	**Proactive FAQ, guided disclosure**
Agent-to-agent	Not supported	**Native — personal agents can call directly**

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Next Steps & Recommendations

From hackathon prototype to enterprise-grade agentic distribution

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ROADMAP

NOW 0–1 mo — Production Readiness

- Swap beta URL → production Petolo API
- Rotate API key to production credential
- Add Redis for session state persistence
- Implement customer identity verification
- Subscribe to policy issuance webhooks

NEXT 1–3 mo — Scale & Multi-channel

- Expose tools as MCP server — discoverable by any personal agent
- Add WhatsApp / voice channel wrappers
- Extend to cat insurance and liability products
- Enable prompt caching (80% cost reduction at scale)
- Add conversation analytics dashboard

FUTURE 3–12 mo — Enterprise Distribution

- Open the MCP server to approved personal agent platforms
- B2B: white-label the Zurich Agent for broker networks
- Cross-sell signals: agent detects life events and triggers relevant products
- Claims co-pilot: extend same architecture to claims journey
- Group rollout: replicate for other DA Direkt / Zurich markets

COST MODEL

Stage	Model	Cost per journey	At 10k journeys/mo	With prompt caching
Zurich Agent	claude-sonnet-4-6	~€0.05	~€500/mo	~€100/mo
Customer Agent	claude-haiku-4-5	~€0.003	~€30/mo	~€6/mo
Total	—	**~€0.05**	**~€530/mo**	**~€106/mo**

Vision: The K9 Agent architecture is the blueprint for Zurich's agentic distribution layer. The same pattern — Zurich Agent + tool layer + product APIs — can power any insurance product, any channel, and any personal agent platform that adopts MCP. Built once, distributed everywhere.